



Apple coming with new mode

Latest macOS Monterey beta shows Apple still working on 'High Power' mode to boost MacBook. <https://digit.in/oct21-20>



FCC to prevent sim attacks

The FCC plans to introduce new rules for US mobile carriers to prevent SIM swapping attacks. <https://digit.in/oct21-20>

Saregama Carvaan Musicbar

A budget soundbar with built-in songs, average sound output

The Saregama Carvaan speakers have carved out a nice niche for themselves, offering users some of the best Indian classics along with pretty decent speakers. With the Saregama Carvaan Musicbar, the company has tried to offer users a soundbar that can sit below their TV and play some of their favourite classic music with the push of a button. Does the soundbar deliver when it comes to performance?

BUILD AND DESIGN

The Saregama Carvaan Musicbar has a very simple design. It has a simple rectangle form factor with curved edges. The top is plastic with a slightly textured finish so it does not look cheap. The front drivers are covered by a non-removable grill. The soundbar isn't very large and will fit comfortably under a 50 or 55-inch TV. The soundbar is accompanied by a subwoofer which has a duct at the back and a side-firing 6.5-inch driver. The driver is on the right of the subwoofer. The subwoofer connects to the soundbar via a wire.

While the design of the soundbar is nice and the build acceptable, there are two things that are a slight hindrance. One is the fact that the power brick is external, which means you will have to make space for it in your entertainment setup. The second is that the tabletop grip of the soundbar comes separately and is not attached to the bar.

For its price, the soundbar has a handsome number of connectivity options. For wireless, you get FM and Bluetooth 5.0. You also get a 3.2mm AUX input, USB port, coaxial and HDMI ARC. You get an HDMI cable in the box which is nice.

SETUP

Setting up the soundbar is extremely easy. Place the soundbar under the TV or wall-mount it. Connect the sub-

woofer to the bar via the cable. Connect the soundbar to the TV via the HDMI cable and ensure your TV's audio out is set to HDMI ARC. Switch on the soundbar and you are good to go!

PERFORMANCE

Before we delve into the performance, know that the biggest USP of the Saregama Carvaan Musicbar is the fact that it comes preloaded with 500 evergreen hits including the likes of *O Mere Dil Ke Chain*, *Do Lafzon Ki Hai Dil Ki Kahani*, *Tum Aa Gaye Ho Noor Aa Gaya*, *Ek Ajnabee Haseena Se*, *Yeh Jo Mohabbat Hai* and so many more that we were transported to the era when we heard these songs for the first time. So, the 500 preload songs are a boon, but there is a bit of a downside here as well. There is no display on the soundbar to let you know what song is on and you have to refer to the provided booklet of a list of songs to navigate.

Speaking of the sound quality of the speaker for the built-in songs, it is average at best. Playing the same classical song via Bluetooth led to a slightly better quality which has led us to believe that the compression used to fit 500 songs on this bar is the reason for the lacklustre experience with the preloaded songs.

There are four sound presets you can choose from – music, movie, vocal and 3D. You can also control the bass and treble via the soundbar remote.

Coming to music, the sound signature feels all over the place. A song like



BUILD	68
FEATURES	60
PERFORMANCE	50
VALUE	60

Over and Over by Hot Chip has a thumpy bass to it and the true bass was only felt when we switched to the 3D audio preset, while on the music preset, the bass felt slightly lacking.

Moving over to movies and TV shows, the vocals are clear but there is no distinct sound separation or channel shift. While the audio is acceptable, the only downside is that the soundbar can get tinny and the sound output suffers at high volumes.

VERDICT

If sound quality is of prime importance to you and you are looking for a soundbar under ₹10,000, then you have a lot of options to choose from. What the Saregama Carvaan Musicbar has going for it is ample connectivity options, a simple design and 500 preloaded classic songs. The soundbar works acceptably if you keep the volume below 50 percent. Considering the large catalogue of preloaded songs, we wish the soundbar had a display to more easily navigate the built-in songs.

—Sameer Mitha

SPECIFICATIONS

SUBWOOFER: Yes (6.5-inch) | AUDIO INPUTS: HDMI ARC, Coaxial in, USB, Bluetooth 5.0, FM and AUX-In. | SOUNDBAR DIMENSION: 900mm x 80mm x 80mm | SUBWOOFER DIMENSIONS: 250mm x 316mm x 300mm | HDMI INPUT: 0 | HDMI OUTPUT (AUDIO RETURN CHANNEL): 1 | DRIVERS: 4 x 2.5-inch drivers | 500 preloaded songs | SOUND OUTPUT: 120W

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